CAREER GLITCH · SHORT · SIMPLE · NO BORING PARTS

LAUNDROMAT OWNER IN THE AI ERA

The most automated business on this list still breaks, floods and fills with quarters — owners win on operations, not effort.

★ TL;DR — Around ~$75K on the site's scale for a working store, startable in 1–6 months of deal-hunting with no license. The catch: you buy the business first — the capital and the lease are the real entry exam. ★

THE CAREER GLITCH TAKE

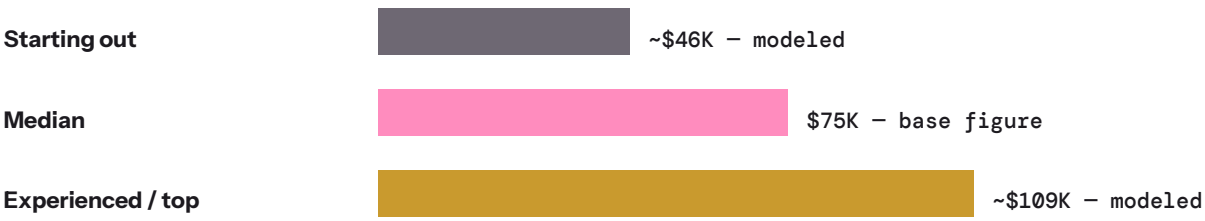
OUR TAKE: YES — WITH EYES OPEN

MEDIAN ~$75K · TRAINING 1-6 months · AI RISK LOW

- Semi-absentee by design: machines do the washing; attendants and systems do much of the rest.
- Location and lease terms decide more than hustle ever will.
- Payment apps and remote monitoring run the floor; repairs keep a human — or a good technician — close.

The site's take, built from this profession's numbers in the Career Glitch base.

THE MONEY — LOOK AT THE BARS



The Career Glitch base figure for Laundromat Owner is a ~$75K median (compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). The starting and top bars are modeled around that median — orientation, not a promise. Pay swings hard by state, employer and experience: check live postings in your state before planning around any number.

WHAT DOES A LAUNDROMAT OWNER ACTUALLY DO?

- ✓ Keep machines running: cleaning, minor repairs, vendor calls
- ✓ Manage attendants, cash and card systems and supplies
- ✓ Handle wash-and-fold and commercial accounts
- ✓ Watch the numbers: turns per day, utilities, rent

Think: a tiny utility company the neighborhood pays by the load.

WHAT AI ALREADY TOOK (AND WHAT IT CAN'T)

THE ROBOT	THE HUMAN
Card and app payment, remote machine monitoring and wash-and-fold ordering automate daily operations. Cameras and alerts reduce the need to be on site.	Judging a store's real books before buying, negotiating the lease, and fixing — or sourcing fixes for — machines: the money decisions stay human.

⚠ **Seller financials are famously optimistic; verify with utility bills and tax returns, or overpay for someone else's problem.**

THE VIBE — IS THIS YOUR LIFE?

THE JOB IS	THE JOB IS NOT
✓ No inventory, few employees, no receivables ✓ Open long hours without you standing there ✓ Wash-and-fold and pickup routes add margin	✗ Utility bills and machine repairs are relentless ✗ A bad lease quietly eats the profit for years ✗ Vandalism and breakdowns pick their own schedule

Good fit? A numbers-first buyer who likes systems more than people management.
Bad fit? You need income without capital, or you hate negotiating leases.

THE FORK — PICK ONE DOOR

DOOR A — BUY AN EXISTING STORE	DOOR B — BUY TIRED, RE-TOOL
The standard route: a store with verifiable books, a long lease and working equipment. Brokers and direct owner listings both exist; diligence — utility records, tax returns, machine ages — decides whether it's a business or a bill.	Acquire a neglected store cheaply, replace key machines, and add card payment and wash-and-fold. Higher upside, real renovation risk — the neighborhood has to support the comeback.

Smart move: Negotiate the lease before the price: a long lease with options is worth more than a small discount on old machines.

Where you land after: One healthy store → a second store, or added routes: pickup and delivery, commercial accounts.

YOUR ROADMAP — 6 STEPS

1	2	3	4	5	6
LEARN THE	SET YOUR	TOUR AND	NEGOTIATE LEASE	TAKE OVER	GROW THE

STEP 1 — Learn the math

FREE · TODAY

- Understand turns per day, rent share and utility costs — the numbers that run the business.
- Read real listings and their asking prices skeptically.

STEP 2 — Set your buy box

WEEKS

- Define the area, size, lease minimum and equipment age you'll accept.
- Line up financing conversations early; sellers will ask.

STEP 3 — Tour and verify

MONTHS 1-3

- Visit stores at peak and off-peak; count actual customers.
- Verify income with utility bills and tax returns, never the brochure alone.

STEP 4 — Negotiate lease and sale

MONTHS 2-5

- Lease length and options first; equipment list and price second.
- Include a transition period with the seller in the deal.

STEP 5 — Take over and stabilize

FIRST 90 DAYS

- Deep clean, fix the obvious, keep attendants and routines steady.
- Add card or app payment if the store is coin-only.

STEP 6 — Grow the margin

MONTH 6+

- Wash-and-fold, pickup and delivery, and a commercial account or two.
- Reinvest in the highest-failure machines before they fail.

FIRST 90 DAYS — JUST DO THIS

- Today: learn the core numbers and scan current listings.
- Days 1–30: buy box written; broker and owner outreach started.
- Days 31–60: store tours with a verification checklist in hand.

□ Days 61–90: a candidate store in diligence, or a sharper search underway.

□ Day 90: you know exactly what you'll buy and what you won't — the deal follows the box.

NEXT — MAKE IT PERSONAL

This roadmap is the same for everyone. Your life is not.

- Not sure this career fits YOU? Take the Big Career Test — 50 questions, your top-3 matches and one honest “probably NOT you”. → careerglitch.com/#test
- Already sure? Turn AI into Your Personal Career Mentor — a 2,300-word system that interviews you first, checks your hours, budget and deadline honestly, and builds YOUR plan into a Notion dashboard. → careerglitch.com/#prompt

★ **BORING BUSINESS. CLEAN MONEY.** ★

CAREER GLITCH · Figures: Career Glitch profession base (medians and training ranges compiled from U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics, Occupational Outlook Handbook ranges). Modeled bars are estimates around the base median. License and certification rules vary by state — verify with your state board before paying for any program.